

Sukrit Mittal, Ph.D.

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I am the Director of AI Research at Franklin Templeton, where I lead applied research at the intersection of AI, optimization, and financial decision-making. My work spans Generative AI, reinforcement learning, interpretable machine learning, and optimization, with a focus on turning advanced methods into practical tools for investment research, portfolio decisions, forecasting, and enterprise workflows. I work closely with data scientists, engineers, product stakeholders, and domain experts to design agentic and human-in-the-loop systems that improve reasoning, efficiency, and decision support. With over eight years of research experience and active collaboration with leading researchers, I am currently driving work in AI-assisted factor modeling, and generative AI systems for knowledge- centric financial workflows.

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE [See LinkedIn for more details]

Faculty of Finance Dec. 2025 - Present
International Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Hyderabad

AI Office Sep. 2025 - Present
Franklin Templeton Investments, Hyderabad, Telangana, India
Director, Principal Research Scientist - AI Research
Operating at the intersection of AI research, product, and business leadership to translate emerging AI capabilities into scalable investment and operational solutions.

- Defining and driving the firm's long-term AI research agenda across generative AI, agentic workflows, reinforcement learning, simulation, and optimization.
- Developing reusable AI frameworks and "AI playbooks" that enable the rapid creation of domain-specific copilots, reasoning systems, and human-in-the-loop decision support tools.
- Partnering with senior leadership, product teams, researchers, and engineering to identify high-value AI opportunities and convert them into usable capabilities.
- Managing and mentoring a growing research team while establishing technical direction, research standards, experimentation frameworks, and innovation roadmaps.
- Fostering relationships with academic community to enhance the research outcomes.

AI & Digital Transformation Jan. 2024 - Aug. 2025
Franklin Templeton Investments, Hyderabad, Telangana, India
Senior Research Scientist - AI & Optimization
Driving foundational research and applied AI development in generative models and reinforcement learning for next-generation investment solutions.

- Spearheading innovation within the Goals Optimization Engine (GOE), integrating reinforcement learning to enhance goal-based wealth management.
- Operating at a 50:50 split between foundational research (GenAI/RL) and product development, ensuring alignment between theoretical advances and real-world financial use-cases.
- Defining the long-term research agenda based on business priorities, acting as a strategic interface between research and product, and contributing to investment technology roadmaps.
- Representing the research team in the Product Review Committee, ensuring scientific rigor and future-facing capabilities are embedded into product decisions.

Digital Investment Management Jun. 2022 - Dec. 2023
Franklin Templeton Investments, Hyderabad, Telangana, India
Quant Development, Specialist
First research hire on the Goals Optimization Engine (GOE) team, leading the design and development of quantitative solutions for goals-based wealth management at scale.

- Developed and refined optimization models for personalized asset allocation, incorporating risk tolerance, time horizons, and probabilistic goal attainment metrics.
- Introduced scalable frameworks for simulation, validation, and performance attribution of investment strategies under varying market conditions.

Computational Optimization and Innovation Laboratory Feb. 2020 - Jun. 2020
Michigan State University, East Lansing, Michigan, USA
Visiting Researcher (invited by Prof. Kalyanmoy Deb)

EDUCATION

Data Science for Investment Professionals Certificate Jun. 2023 - Jun. 2024
CFA Institute, USA (**Credential**)

Ph.D. in ML-assisted Optimization Jul. 2018 - Aug. 2022
Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee, India CGPA : 9.47/10
Thesis: Machine Learning based Enhancements in Evolutionary Multi-objective Optimization (**Thesis**)
Advisors: Prof. Dhish K. Saxena, Prof. Kalyanmoy Deb and Prof. Erik D. Goodman

B.Tech. in Mechanical Engineering Jul. 2012 - Jun. 2016
Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee, India CGPA : 8.38/10

OTHERS

Recent publications: See full list on Google Scholar

- **Book:** Machine Learning Assisted Evolutionary Multi- and Many-Objective Optimization — Springer 2024 (**link**)
- CARL: Chat Assisted Reinforcement Learning — Preprint (link)
- Converting Expert Deliberation into Financial Signals Through A Context-Aware NLP Pipeline — AIxB 2026 (**link**)
- A Meta Reinforcement Learning Approach to Goals-Based Wealth Management — JFDS 2026 (**link**)
- Interpreting Omega Ratio for Goals Based Wealth Management — JWM 2026 (**link**)

Upcoming talks: 2026 Global Analytics Summit (Austin, USA, Nov'26)

Past talks: JOIM Fall Conference – AI in Finance (Atlanta, USA, Sept'26); Recent Trends in AI – Keynote (IIT Jodhpur, Feb'26); Winter School (IIIT Hyderabad, Dec'25); ACM GECCO'25; IEEE CEC'25; Global Analytics Summit – Keynote (Austin, USA, Nov'24); JOIM Fall Conference – AI in Finance (Boston, USA, Oct'24).